

ELTE Faculty of Informatics - Subject Registration Guide

1. Document Purpose and Overview

This document is a guide for students at ELTE's Faculty of Informatics on how to successfully register for subjects using the Neptun system. It covers planning, a step-by-step process, troubleshooting, and key definitions.

2. The Core Principle: Planned Registration

A stress-free start to the semester requires careful planning before registration opens.

- **Step 1: Review Your Curriculum**
 - Visually track your progress by marking completed subjects, subjects in progress, and new subjects.
 - Select around 30 credits worth of new subjects for the upcoming semester.
 - **Crucially, identify all prerequisites for the subjects you want to take.**
- **Step 2: Check Subject Viability**
 - **Offering:** Confirm the subject is offered this semester. If not, you must inquire about an "exam course" with the relevant department.
 - **Strong Prerequisite:** If a subject has a strong prerequisite and you haven't fulfilled it, you cannot register for the follow-up subject.
 - **Weak Prerequisite:** You should register for the weak prerequisite first. Without fulfilling it, you cannot complete the follow-up subject.
- **Step 3: Understand Registration Order for Composite Subjects**
 - For subjects with a single code ending in "EG": Register for the **Practice** course first, then the Lecture course.
 - For subjects with separate codes ending in "E" (lecture/exam) and "G" (practice): Register for the **Practice (G) subject** first, then the Lecture/Exam **(E) subject**.

3. The Three-Phase Registration Process

Registration in the Neptun system happens in three distinct phases:

- **Phase 1: Preregistration**
 - This is where you indicate your intention to take subjects. It is not a final registration.
 - Departments use this data to plan group sizes.
 - **Action:** Register at the end of the previous semester's exam period.
- **Phase 2: Ranking Period**
 - This is the main registration period where you build your actual schedule.
 - Students are ranked for courses with limited space. A "cut" at the end of this period automatically drops students whose ranking is too low for the available spots.
 - **Action:** Check your ranking half a day before the "cut" to see if you are at risk of being dropped.
- **Phase 3: First-Come, First-Served**
 - This occurs in the first week of classes.
 - It is the last chance to register for any remaining spots.
 - **Action:** Registration is based solely on speed; the ranking system is no longer used.

4. Understanding the Ranking System

When course space is limited, students are ranked using a points system.

- **Key Ranking Criteria:**
 - Students starting their studies and those who used preregistration get 100 points.
 - The subject's importance to your curriculum grants points: Compulsory subjects get the most (80 points), followed by Compulsory Elective (70 points), and others (60 points).
 - Following the ideal curriculum grants 10 points.
 - You get points based on your current semester.

- Special needs students receive 1000 points.
- **Lucky Points:** If students have identical ranking points, Neptun uses a randomly generated "lucky point" to decide who gets the spot. This number is unique to each student and course.

5. Proactive Tips for Students

- Always use the **Preregistration** phase to improve your ranking.
- Regularly **check your Neptun messages** for important notifications, like being dropped from a course.
- Ensure your **email address in Neptun is correct and active**.
- Keep some **funds in your Neptun joint account** to cover potential fees for re-registering for a subject.

6. Troubleshooting Common Registration Issues

- **Problem:** Cannot register for any subjects.
 - **Solution:** You may not have activated your status for the semester, or you may have outstanding debts in Neptun. Check your status and finances.
- **Problem:** Cannot register for a specific subject.
 - **Solution:** The most common reasons are:
 - You have not fulfilled a **prerequisite**.
 - You have already **registered for the subject 3 times** without completing it. This requires a special request to the Dean.
 - The **subject is not offered** this semester. Check your curriculum; autumn semester subjects are only offered in autumn, and spring semester subjects only in spring.

7. Key Definitions and Special Cases

- **Late Registration:**
 - You can request to register for a subject after the deadline only during the **2nd week** of the semester.
 - It is only allowed for credit transfer and only for subjects in your official curriculum.
 - You must submit a request via Neptun.
- **Exam Course:**
 - This is a special exam opportunity for a subject you **registered for in a previous semester but did not complete**, and which is **not offered** in the current semester.
 - You **cannot** request an exam course for a combined subject (ending in EG) if you failed the practice part.
 - It involves extra fees and must be requested from the department in charge of the subject.
- **BSc Students Taking MSc Subjects:**
 - This is only permitted in the **last semester** of your BSc studies if you have a **maximum of 10 credits left** (excluding your thesis).
 - It requires a "Request for Equity" and supporting documentation from the lecturer.
 - The deadline is strict: Friday of the first week of the study term.